Decentralizing the decision-making process, shaping data product owner positions, developing multiple cross-functional teams, and shifting responsibilities requires a significant restructuring of existing organizational charts. Moreover, such changes come with costs in time, brainpower, and finances.

Federated governance requires the development of novel procedures; this extends from decision-making to communication methods. These responsibilities and principles have to be appropriately identified and federated.

As we come to the end of this chapter, you should now have a better understanding of data mesh as a joint technological and organizational paradigm (as well as its underlying principles). In chapter 2, we will show you how to build a data mesh in your organization within a month.

Summary

- The cornerstone of the data mesh is decentralization—moving ownership and responsibility for data closer to its source. This approach aims to keep data in sync with the subject matter, removing bottlenecks caused by long data pipes and central team inefficiencies.
- The data mesh is a socio-technical architecture paradigm based on principles of domain-oriented data ownership, treatment of data as a product, federated computational governance, and self-serve data infrastructure as a platform.
- Domain-oriented data ownership means the data and its relevant components should be owned, maintained, and developed by the people closest to it (the people inside the data's domain).
- Treating data as a product means a conscious design of the outcome presented to the outside environment, clearly assigned roles for ensuring that outcome availability and quality, and autonomy of development required to produce that outcome.
- Federated computational governance means two things. First, the responsibility for data governance is split between the central body